



FAMILY COURT DATA REPORT · STATE SERIES · NO. 36

OHIO

WHAT FAMILIES ARE REPORTING.

Pulled from the Family Rights Registry — a cross-location dataset on what pro se parents are actually experiencing inside Ohio's family courts and child-welfare system.

272

OHIO FAMILIES ON RECORD · 459
CHILDREN IMPACTED · 18 MONTHS
MEDIAN MONTHS LOST OF PARENTING
TIME

REPORT GENERATED
JULY 16, 2026

COUNTIES REPRESENTED
76 OF 88

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01 NAMED COURT ACTORS · OHIO

A name appears below only after 3 or more independent families have named the same actor in Ohio. Submitter names, emails, and contact details are never published. Comments below are direct family reports — one per family — with all identifying information removed.

Kristen K Johnson

JUDGE · HANCOCK · 10 SUBMISSIONS

"She refused to admit my emails with CPS as evidence in my trial for custody. However during appeal the Ohio Thrid District court of Appeals did accept jurisdiction of my emails but still upheld her judgment. Denied due process. Failed to accept my emails (that proved i was in contact with the agency) as evidence saying they looked copy and pasted. Appointed me a lawyer without my consent and allowed that lawyer to represent me in a motions hearing i had notification of" **HANCOCK COUNTY**

"She never once spoke to me. I was never given due process nor aware of my first court date the day they where removed. Wasn't till after the court date susan from cps told me I had a chance to speak and wasn't there. They fumbled bad with my case. And still to this date the man that rapped my daughter walks free. Never once questioned or brought in. Because she was 16 just turned 16 they said it was consensual and brushed it under the rug"

"Used blanket statements on all family not there to represent themselves. Allows Kelli Millet to lie on the stand. Overruled many objections. Cherry picked the lines she wanted to deny and progress with family."

"She refused to admit my emails with CPS as evidence in my trial for custody. However during appeal the Ohio Thrid District court of Appeals did accept jurisdiction of my emails but still upheld her judgment." **HANCOCK COUNTY**

"Prior cps prosecuting attorney, no due process, denied intervention, kinship, supervised visits, and custody. Cherry picked evidence and twisted it to fit the narrative ."

"She added and listened to false information. She took my children away from a mother based off false information and continues to keep them away for absolutely no reason!"

"She refuses kinship makes up false allegations makes doin anything requested by the court impossible or looses an doesnt submitt paper work or evidence" **HANCOCK COUNTY**

"She didn't look at my case at all and just decided the mother was the best choice without looking at evidence and blatantly ignored eveidence in court"

"stepped in hours before mediation to rule dad (Indicated forensic interview) would get next day over night weekends."

"didnt show up for court" **HANCOCK**

Create Complaint Packet: <https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/oh-kristen-k-johnson/complaint-packet>

Family-reported pattern context only. Each person must file only their own truthful, first-hand complaint using their own facts, dates, evidence, orders, transcripts, and documents.

01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED**Kevin Greer**JUDGE · HIGHLAND · **9 SUBMISSIONS**

"Denied motion and ignored evidence!! None of them did their job they made up everything. The judge didn't want to listen to us whatsoever that we gave him evidence and they didn't show him any evidence and that he ruled with them over us. He delayed hearings gave them more time biased, he didn't sign half of his records he had to click record sign it things like that you can put well. She really really wasn't on our case that much it was mainly James he was the one he was his assistant prosecutor. Please help me!!!!"

"The night motions with clearing convicted evidence that we were telling the truth we had proof of everything house pay rent all the time it took receipts look presentable all that, and he still decided to go with them He ignored my evidence and motions with my evidence attached to them, and believed the prosecutor and the hospital" **HIGHLAND COUNTY**

"Ignored evidence, agreed with prosecutors, looked at me in a bad light no matter my attorney evidence and much more Denied visitation, listened to prosecutors instead of me and my attorney evidence, assumed my side was lying no matter the statements"

"Judge refuse evidences would not allow me to speak other then yes or no didnt want to hear me out did not have children's best interest at heart"

"Ignored my evidence and motions filed throughout case, terminating my rights." **HIGHLAND COUNTY COURT OF COMMON PLEAS**

"Denied motion, ignored evidence"

"Ignored evidence" **HIGHLAND COUNTY**

Create Complaint Packet: <https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/oh-kevin-greer/complaint-packet>

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01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED**Dennis Kirk**GAL / CHILD REPRESENTATIVE · HIGHLAND COUNTY · **7 SUBMISSIONS**

"Didn't do his job, just went off cos and the prosecutor and lied on oath Didn't do his job didn't supervise any visits didn't watch me with my daughter at all. I called and his secretary told me that they don't do that right now at the beginning, but I did call and then he said on that I never called and then he just went with everything piggyback off the prosecutor and everything, and he even used the word piggyback He didn't meet with us or do his job he lied on stand saying we never called him but I showed a recording we did talk to his assistant and played it for the court"

HIGHLAND COUNTY

"Denied motion and ignored evidence!! None of them did their job they made up everything. The judge didn't want to listen to us whatsoever that we gave him evidence and they didn't show him any evidence and that he ruled with them over us. He delayed hearings gave them more time biased, he didn't sign half of his records he had to click record sign it things like that you can put well. She really really wasn't on our case that much it was mainly James he was the one he was his assistant prosecutor. Please help me!!!!" **HIGHLAND**

"My children's therapists and myself reached out to Mr Kirk from Oct 2024 to March 2025 with no return communication. He then made claims as facts, brought to him via an email from a concerned citizen, yet never spoke to myself or others to verify this concern. While communication was not provided to myself or the therapists, Mr Kirk kept communications with the defendant and his counsel. As of May 5 2026, he has been voted in to Higland County's Juvenile judge position set to take oath in November."

"Mr kirk made no reasonable efforts to put my daughter back in my care, despite having long term housing and employment. He filed no motions with the court on my daughter's behalf. Never came to my house for a visit and I called his office early in the case to setup a home visit and he said that he doesn't complete home visits till after the adjudication and deposition. He is now taking Judge Greers position as the juvenile judge."

HIGHLAND COUNTY

"He would seem like your friend and on the children's side then go into court and deny any change or say was not in best interest for children to be returned home" **HIGHLAND COUNTY/JUVENILE GUARDIAN**

"Fabricated evidence" **HIGHLAND****Create Complaint Packet:** <https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/oh-dennis-kirk/complaint-packet>

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01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED**Jennifer Storer**CPS WORKER · HIGHLAND · **6 SUBMISSIONS**

"Denied motion and ignored evidence!! None of them did their job they made up everything. The judge didn't want to listen to us whatsoever that we gave him evidence and they didn't show him any evidence and that he ruled with them over us. He delayed hearings gave them more time biased, he didn't sign half of his records he had to click record sign it things like that you can put well. She really really wasn't on our case that much it was mainly James he was the one he was his assistant prosecutor. Please help me!!!!"

"Living with the prosecutor and she's the one who got the rule 6 from him to take my daughter Get the hospital to discharge me because I won't speak to her without a Lawyer present she lies in comes back rooms and just then she gets double six but I got the hospital record saying a totally completely different story where she called and had the rule six when she got there before speaking to us The first caseworker"

HIGHLAND COUNTY OHIO

"The first caseworker Get the hospital to discharge me because I won't speak to her without a Lawyer present she lies in comes back rooms and just then she gets double six but I got the hospital record saying a totally completely different story where she called and had the rule six when she got there before speaking to us" **HIGHLAND COUNTY**

"Obtained a rule 6 based on false information and filed a false complaint. Was in a relationship and living with the assistant prosecutor that was on the case." **HIGHLAND COUNTY**

"Delayed reunification, lied to me about giving my daughter back to me, refused to listen to my side." **LORAIN COUNTY**

"Fabrication evidence"

Create Complaint Packet: <https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/oh-jennifer-storer/complaint-packet>

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01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED**Dr. Aimee Thomas**PSYCHOLOGICAL EVALUATOR · RICHLAND COUNTY · **6 SUBMISSIONS**

"Dr. Thomas handled my case unjustly, and set the foundation for the removal of my children indefinitely conspiring with opposing counsel. I had a self defense case in Carroll county Ohio that brought me to this office by the courts and abusers family with the intent to separate me from my child. My parental fitness was never brought up prior to this. They took so long delaying the process, I requested a different evaluator and was denied by the guardian ad litem. This doctor relayed questions from the party that paid for the exam to use against me in order to remove my child in a deceitful manner. Thomas contacted me via telephone and interrogated me relaying questions from the opposing party. When I told her that I wanted to speak with my attorney, she continued asking questions. She explained that she would write that I refused to answer making it look like I wasn't cooperating. She claimed I was devoid in showing affection to my child because I chose to allow my child to lead play time during her observation. Thomas took it upon herself leading my child to the restroom while having me complete a written test without notifying myself or my mother sitting in the waiting room. I had to dismiss myself to check on my child that she had in a restroom with the door closed. Because of her report, my child was removed from my family, and sent to an abusive home in Mississippi where they are alienating me from my child. The family continues to utilize Thomas' report in the courts at every attempt I make to fight for my child and has defamed my character in various states. I was ordered to undergo a parenting class as part of Thomas' recommendations where we were taught to report the very thing I witness My child going through currently. My child has never been harmed by me or any of my family members. Thomas provided all these recommendations to the court, but did not provide me with any contacts or sources to get these things completed. Thomas recommended I take medication indefinitely against recommendations from the Department of Veteran Affairs. Thomas set the foundation demonstrating a pattern of incompetence as well as corruption drafting a report I have been denied full access to. This report has been circulated with court officials and used in retaliation without my consent. I am an honorable Veteran that was misdiagnosed and mistreated by this evaluator in her participation in this case."

"She completed her psychological eval after 2 of the mandated 4 visits because I knew something wasn't right with the how she was treating me when I was there, so I declined to attend any further appointments and she still completed the eval, I filed a complaint to the board of psychology in Ohio and the opened an investigation because after those 2 visits she wrote in her report that she thinks I have bipolar even though I endured her verbal demands in her office like she has it, plus my own anxiety doctor had only ever diagnosed me with anxiety" **SUMMIT COUNTY**

"Did not review any of my evidence before filing a false report"

Create Complaint Packet: <https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/oh-dr-aimee-thomas/complaint-packet>

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01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED

Kelli Miller

CPS WORKER · HANCOCK · 7 SUBMISSIONS

"Said I was unsafe, never did background check or home study. Said I didn't protect my grandchildren when in fact I had and always have. Had him since he was 2 months old every single weekend. She filed a false report stating FRESH RIBS PLURAL and that he was SEEN in person by their doctor- a lie. He had a single old hairline fix rib nobody knew about. Perjury, met children one time, attended my sons criminal hearing with foster parents. Trial by ambush." **HANCOCK COUNTY CPS**

"Falsified reports, changed drug test to a positive. Changed documents after signed. Lied on the stand. Claimed to attempt a home visit when no contact was ever made. Also claimed that home visits were denied but were done every month and recording of them prove it."

"Lied about the results of a drug test, that was eventually overturned at court by Judge Kristen Johnson. Delayed granting my visitation request for months, my lawyer had to contact her and demand a response"

"She altered drugs tests lied twisted everything said my son was adopted he has not been pay childsupport currently no visits or contact or response from cps or family court" **HANCOCK COUNTY CPS**

"Lied on stand. Did NOT contact any family. Never returned phone calls for outreach and placement. Did dual roles at agency. Abuse of power and retaliation."

Create Complaint Packet: <https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/oh-kelli-miller/complaint-packet>

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Randall Galbraith

OTHER · HANCOCK COUNTY CPS HEAD OF CPS · 5 SUBMISSIONS

"False allegations were sent to Hancock County from Williams County under the guise of "third-party, neutral investigation". It was far from neutral, based on evidence discovered. Hancock County JFS then released confidential information through the US Postal service in a clear view window envelope. No accountability to this day."

"He ignored my filed letter complaint as soon as the case opened. He ignored my attorney and her communication. He ignored my moms complaint he recieved certified. He did not return phone calls either. His only response was the letter was received. He has backed Kelli Miller and her abuse of power." **HANCOCK COUNTY DIRECTOR OF DJFS**

"Refused to investigate the handling of my case when i asked several times. Violated my due process rights"

"Refuse kinship reunification an never returns calls very disrespectful on the phone an in person"

"Would NOT file my grievance said he'd see me in court." **HANCOCK CPS DIRECTOR**

Create Complaint Packet: <https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/oh-randall-galbraith/complaint-packet>

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01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED

Adam W. Wilgus

JUDGE · TUSCARAWAS · 4 SUBMISSIONS

"He assured me that I would be offered communication accommodations due to being autistic. IT NEVER HAPPENED. CPS is DEMANDING I change myself to suit their communication styles. I HAVE AUTISM and I AM RIGID. THAT DOES NOT MEAN I AM INEPT. IT MEANS I AM DIFFERENT. I have the right to fully participate in this case but I haven't been given the chance. Things are happening TO ME, without letting me be apart of the conversation. My case is based on rumors started by people who USED TO CONTROL MY LIFE."

"Ignored my son bruised every visit and evidence from my parents and my dad collapsed in their parking lot they let jfs continue court where my dad couldn't cross examine and made me stay there while my dad died twice"

"It was his court room his magistrates making rulings and orders and he later after 1 whole year removed himself for conflict of interest is the biggest thing so how is this even still happening"

"He allowed lies and hearsay in the permanency trial"

Create Complaint Packet: <https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/oh-adam-w-wilgus/complaint-packet>

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Casey Cook

CPS WORKER · HIGHLAND COUNTY · 5 SUBMISSIONS

"Lied about everything Lied on oath He maliciously came out here thought we were lying about a flat tire because we had to cancel last minute because the FAC rules that you have to follow and if you are late, you can't go to your visit. If you're early, you can't be early. You can't wait in the parking lot none of that you will get wrote up like quick as anything, but he instead of coming and calling to see if we need a ride to go see our daughter and to visit with him, he maliciously comes out here and instead of knocking on the door he gets out of his car, goes directly over to our car and starts taking pictures saying we're lying about our flat tire and then lies on the stand saying that he was going to knock on the door and that's what's going on in your appeal. They're saying that that he was coming to knock on the door. I have cameras. We had to cancel a visit one time bc of a flat tire last minute and he thought we was lying so he came out and got out of his car and went over to ours and started talking pictures"

"Denied motion and ignored evidence!! None of them did their job they made up everything. The judge didn't want to listen to us whatsoever that we gave him evidence and they didn't show him any evidence and that he ruled with them over us. He delayed hearings gave them more time biased, he didn't sign half of his records he had to click record sign it things like that you can put well. She really really wasn't on our case that much it was mainly James he was the one he was his assistant prosecutor. Please help me!!!!" **HIGHLAND**

"Violated my rights on April 1, 2024, coming on my property and recording within the curtilage of my home without permission. Also ignored exculpatory evidence identified presented." **HIGHLAND COUNTY**

"Fabricated evidence" **HIGHLAND**

Create Complaint Packet: <https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/oh-casey-cook/complaint-packet>

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01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED**Christine Sayre**CUSTODY EVALUATOR · SUMMIT · **4 SUBMISSIONS**

"Deemed an "expert" after 2 years of being a therapist. Has no idea what she is doing and Summit uses her findings as the bible, but she's terrible! Had to have 4 others dispute her findings, including pros way above her, like psychiatry level! She believes in reunification camps and punishing children from rightfully turning away from abusive parents. She's sick and has caused several moms in our county to lose custody for false findings."

"Recommended increased time and custody rights to father despite documented DV towards mother and children via ER records and with no involvement in their medical care or schooling in the past or present." **STARK**

"Diagnosed my child with an unknown trauma knowing exactly what that trauma was... ABUSE! Just another actor protecting the system!" **STARK**

Create Complaint Packet: <https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/oh-christine-sayre/complaint-packet>

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Hon. Anneka P. CollinsJUDGE · HIGHLAND · **4 SUBMISSIONS**

"Denied motion and ignored evidence!! None of them did their job they made up everything. The judge didn't want to listen to us whatsoever that we gave him evidence and they didn't show him any evidence and that he ruled with them over us. He delayed hearings gave them more time biased, he didn't sign half of his records he had to click record sign it things like that you can put well. She really really wasn't on our case that much it was mainly James he was the one he was his assistant prosecutor. Please help me!!!!"

"Prosecutor of highland county Ohio she got my hospital records and used them as my newborn daughters records and they didn't even go through them in court because they was MY RECORD!!!!"

"Ignored exculpatory evidence identified presented and maliciously prosecuted my wife and I."

"Denied motion without hearing"

Create Complaint Packet: <https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/oh-anika-collins/complaint-packet>

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01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED

James Roeder

ATTORNEY (OPPOSING) · HIGHLAND · 4 SUBMISSIONS

"Denied motion and ignored evidence!! None of them did their job they made up everything. The judge didn't want to listen to us whatsoever that we gave him evidence and they didn't show him any evidence and that he ruled with them over us. He delayed hearings gave them more time biased, he didn't sign half of his records he had to click record sign it things like that you can put well. She really really wasn't on our case that much it was mainly James he was the one he was his assistant prosecutor. Please help me!!!!"

"He's the (assistant) prosecutor and did a juvenile rule 6 without a judge or magistrate and waiting a whole day after cps receiving the phone call of the hospital saying "mother is fine and I don't see her leaving with baby tonight" and caseworker saying "okay we will be up tomorrow morning and let things settle down"" **HIGHLAND COUNTY**

"Delayed any attempt at reunification and ignored exculpatory evidence."

"Denied motion without hearing"

Create Complaint Packet: <https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/oh-james-roeder/complaint-packet>

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Rhonda G. Burggraf

JUDGE · MARION · 4 SUBMISSIONS

"I obtained custody of the child through kinship care and now have permanent custody. He has been displaying increasingly unruly behavior. Rhonda has instructed me to allow him to remain out running the streets until 11:00 p.m. and not report him missing until 1:00 a.m. I have serious concerns about this approach given his history. He has known violent behavior, a history of drug use, an assault on a police officer charge, and has tested positive for drugs while on probation. Despite these incidents, I have not seen any meaningful action taken to address these ongoing safety concerns."

"Rhonda ordered that I should have zero medical rights to my daughter because I didn't give her medication. This decision is a personal choice in which all parents have the right to choose for their child. However Rhonda takes these personal rights away from the parent and demands her own authority. Her decision has caused my child to experience even greater harm from the medical field. One in which her life is forever changed."

"Denied any safety issues after documented drugs in the home and a dangerous dog bite."

"Refused to hear a motion Denied my motion without hearing"

Create Complaint Packet: <https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/oh-rhonda-g-burggraf/complaint-packet>

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01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED

Aimee Drescher

THERAPIST / COUNSELOR · WOOD · 3 SUBMISSIONS

"Violated every single rule in psychology as she's friends with Julie Hoffman and they refer each other clients. She was the PhD to back the gal on this safety plan. She has removed me from the ability to partake in his therapy there and did neurological psychological testing without my consent as his custodial and residential parent and without my knowledge."

"She was ordered to do a court order evaluation of my husband and I. She came back and said after not talking to my therapists or psychiatrist. She said she couldn't rule out "factitious disorder by proxy". She had no evidence of that rule out. Because of that rule out, I lost custody."

Create Complaint Packet: <https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/oh-aimee-drescher/complaint-package>

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Christina Marie Joliat

GAL / CHILD REPRESENTATIVE · CUYAHOGA COUNTY · 3 SUBMISSIONS

"Denied motion and ignored evidence!! None of them did their job they made up everything. The judge didn't want to listen to us whatsoever that we gave him evidence and they didn't show him any evidence and that he ruled with them over us. He delayed hearings gave them more time biased, he didn't sign half of his records he had to click record sign it things like that you can put well. She really really wasn't on our case that much it was mainly James he was the one he was his assistant prosecutor. Please help me!!!!"

"Sided with father gave him full custody after being burned multiple times and multiple CPS reports. Made false statements in report that could cause harm/ defamation of character. Made false statements in report/ ignored child abuse and neglectful parenting"

Create Complaint Packet: <https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/oh-christina-marie-joliat/complaint-package>

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Emily Mothmiller

ATTORNEY (OPPOSING) · SHELBY · 3 SUBMISSIONS

"Aquired restricted court documents from a 3rd party of a juvenile case in a different state with kids not involved in this case in any way to discredit a witness and those documents were fully unredacted and compromised those childrens identities. Lied about having them and lied about redacting them" **SHELBY COUNTY**

"Uses "evidence" gotten under false pretenses and exaggerates in court to try and manipulate you into emotional responses and answers"

"Files retaliatory motions to keep parties wrapped up in legal fees"

Create Complaint Packet: <https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/oh-emily-mothmiller/complaint-package>

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J.D. Wagner,

ATTORNEY (MINE) · HIGHLAND COUNTY · 3 SUBMISSIONS

Create Complaint Packet: <https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/oh-j-d-wagner/complaint-package>

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01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED

James Patrick Celebrezze

JUDGE · CUYAHOGA · 3 SUBMISSIONS

"I am living in absolute H 3// right now. My son has a rare genetic disorder and had a bit of an episode that was unusual for him. A traumatic experience triggered him to act out of character and lock me out of my house. The police were called (not by me) and the short of it is they charged him criminally. He just turned 14 and has a 72 IQ. He is kind and has a great personality. Since i was the alleged "victim " of the "crime" i figured it would be easy to get him out of juvenile detention. His attorney, my attorney, we are both fighting to have him freed. The GAL and judge want him to go to an institution!!!! It's insanity, absolute insanity. They had the board of DD and our whole team try to get him placed inpatient. It was denied and the appeal was denied because he isn't remotely even CLOSE to needing that level of care!!! So their genius idea was to have CPS take temporary custody. I absolutely REFUSED. They held a pretend hearing (pretended that it mattered what I wanted or what my son's therapist wanted), granted CPS temporary custody, even THEY can't get him in patient and they're using juvenile detention as a day care. Meanwhile my son has been assaulted THREE TIMES, moved 3 times to different pods, and has been fed dairy every single day even though he is medically allergic to it. We are living in an unbelievable nightmare. There is no end in sight. Believe me when i say they are coming for your disabled children!!!!"

"He has approved decisions that contained unfounded allegations and did not comply with local rules. He has refused my subpoenas while simultaneously allowing opposing parties. Has allowed a GAL to remain in a case that expressed explicit bias" CUYAHOGA COUNTY

"Ignore evidence of child abuse/ making false statements in order."

Create Complaint Packet: <https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/oh-james-patrick-celebrezze/complaint-packet>

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Public threshold rule: Names are grouped conservatively by normalized spelling, role, and location. Common titles, punctuation, casing, and middle initials collapse together. Close misspellings are not auto-merged without admin review. Only family-direct submissions count toward the public threshold.

THE HEADLINE NUMBERS

OHIO AT A GLANCE.

Across 272 Ohio families reporting through the Family Rights Registry, the patterns are consistent: long durations in court, serious financial loss, and a disproportionate number of parents going unrepresented because they ran out of money fighting.

CHILDREN IMPACTED 459 269 of 272 families reported child counts	MEDIAN FAMILY BURDEN \$80,000 median across 133 families reporting 3+ categories	MEDIAN MONTHS LOST 18 of parenting time	WENT PRO SE 52.6% 143 of 272 who answered; 112 of 272 ran out of money
SUBMISSIONS 272	AVG CHILDREN / FAMILY 1.7	FAMILIES REPORTING CHILDREN 269 of 272	COUNTIES REPRESENTED 76

WHY THIS REPORT EXISTS.

On January 29, 2024, I lost custody of all five of my children.

- NO TRIAL.
- NO QUESTIONING.
- NO SUBSTANTIATED ABUSE.

It took only a signature on an ex parte emergency order to erase a mother. I refused to disappear. I fought back, and built the Family Rights Registry so Ohio families — and families across every represented location — would stop being invisible to the data. This report is their record.

— MEG · [STANDWITHMEG.COM](https://standwithmeg.com)

03 THE COST OF OHIO FAMILY COURT

Legal fees are the largest reported expense, but they are not the only one. Lost wages, evaluation costs, and reunification services compound the financial loss — pushing most families toward pro se representation once their savings run out.

EXPENSE CATEGORY	RESPONSES	MEDIAN	MEAN	TOTAL REPORTED
Attorney Fees	172	\$15,000	\$58,473	\$10,057,340
Lost Wages	136	\$10,000	\$47,085	\$6,403,530
Other Court Fees	84	\$2,750	\$5,591	\$469,639
Therapy / Evaluations	99	\$2,500	\$6,273	\$620,980
Reunification Services	81	\$500	\$3,195	\$258,770
GAL Fees	132	\$3,000	\$8,300	\$1,095,578
Asset Loss ¹	99	\$30,000	—	—
Median Family Burden (133 families reporting 3+ categories)	—	\$80,000	—	—

Median vs. mean: Median is the middle reported amount, so it better reflects the typical reporting family when a few very large expenses appear. Mean is the average across reporting families and can be pulled higher by outliers. **Median Family Burden** is the median of total reported expenses across families who reported costs in 3 or more expense categories with a combined total of at least \$1,000 — a true median of real family totals, restricted to families who filled out enough of the financial section to characterize their case and excluding obvious data-entry artifacts.

1. On asset loss: One respondent reported an extreme outlier that skews the mean beyond usefulness. We report the median (\$30,000) and suppress the mean and total, pending data-quality review. Lost Wages also contains wide variance; median is the honest headline.

LOST PARENTING TIME · MONTHS

Median months lost		18	1.5 yrs
Mean months lost		31	2.6 yrs
Total across all families		6,236	519.7 yrs

04 WHO IS REPORTING · OHIO

Most families documenting in Ohio are currently active in, or recently closed out of, long-running cases. Nearly half have lost all contact with their children. Percentages below use only families who answered that specific topic.

CASE STATUS · SYSTEM AFFECTED

CASE STATUS

Active case: stuck or delayed		131	49%
Case closed: within last 2 years		45	17%
Not provided		30	11%
Case closed: more than 2 years ago		29	11%
Not in court but still affected		18	7%

SYSTEM AFFECTED

Both Family Court and CPS		140	52%
Family Court Only		95	35%
Unknown		20	7%
CPS Only		15	6%
Foster Care / Termination of Parental Rights (TPR)		1	0%

DURATION · CUSTODY OUTCOMES

TIME IN SYSTEM

1 – 3 years		87	32%
3 – 5 years		57	21%
5 – 10 years		43	16%
6 months – 1 year		29	11%
Over 10 years		25	9%

CUSTODY STATUS

Visitation Only		94	35%
No Contact / Total Loss of Access		70	26%
50/50 Joint		34	12%
Full Custody		28	10%
Children in Foster Care		27	10%

GEOGRAPHY · ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

TOP COUNTIES

Hancock		19	8%
Cuyahoga		13	6%
Franklin		13	6%
Summit		12	5%
Highland		12	5%
Lucas		10	4%

TOP ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

Family Court False Accusations (Domestic Violence/Abuse/Alienation)		90	33%
False Accusations CPS (Non-Medical) (Vengeful ex-partner, malicious report)		53	19%
Other		30	11%
High Conflict Divorce		28	10%
Medical CPS (Medical Child Abuse allegations, disagreement with doctors)		19	7%

05 PARENT VOICES — OHIO

Selected voice excerpts appear here for readability. Every approved, shareable Ohio comment is printed in full in the appendix that follows.



I have been stripped of my legal rights and majority parenting time to my children through false allegations of parental alienation and unscrupulous actors in the family court system aiding my abusers to weaponize our children to continue patterns of post separation abuse and [...]

— REBECCA

ON THE REPORTED ALLEGATIONS

This CPS and juvenile court system in Scioto County Ohio has destroyed me , my daughter and her 3 children. They failed to provide our family with a full family conference and purposely blocked out the rest of us in order to manipulate my daughter and take her children forever. [...]

— OHIO PARENT · ANONYMOUS

MORE VOICES FROM OHIO

Terminated my Parental Rights in Fraud and destroyed my children.

— PATSY

I am living in absolute H 3// right now. My son has a rare genetic disorder and had a bit of an episode that was unusual for him. A traumatic experience triggered him to act out of character and lock me out of my house. The police were called (not by me) and the short of it is [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

My health is declined, my traumatic brain injury symptoms that have been managed for over a decade have flared up and I've been exacerbated by CPS is involvement and core actors, denying my rights appearance, character assassination by hearsay of those who've never witnessed [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Took my 4 children from a mother they all 4 testified to stay with in an in-camera interview-to retaliate, the court covered it up as MOOT and said I coached OLDER TEENAGERS and SEALED THE DOCKET to cover it up. They allow dad to get away with murder while forcing me to take [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



As a Honorable Veteran, I have witnessed a pattern of corruption and abuse of power in this system concerning my children and I for years. This system has continuously cycled trauma with no relief for victims.

— AUDREY

This system has failed myself and my children and placed all 6 children with the abuser! The GAL on my case didn't even protect them the didn't do her full investigation/job, job and family services CPS WORKER ASHELY STACY LIED ON STANDS AND LIED AND SAID MY CHILDREN SAID STUFF [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It has destroyed us and wreaked havoc on our family. My son was prematurely ripped from his primary caregiver at 2 years of age to be given to a father who was more like a stranger since he was so uninvolved in his son's life prior to retaining a lawyer. The system has failed to [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The American dream is dead, enslaved by corrupt systems that steal our children. Abiding not, by the maternal rights inherently established by God; Creator of the Universe.

— AIMEE

The system did the opposite of what it was supposed to do. It destroyed my family, damaged my children, caused irreversible harm to our relationships, and long-term trauma for us all to continue to deal with.

— KEITH

They only had my kids for a month but kept custody for a year. My children were so traumatized that they were changed for life. It is a demonic spirit, the spirit of decision. I am sorry

— PATRICIA

High conflict custody with abuse mentality emotionally Gal reports in favor and made recommendations judge still won't do anything.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system has violated my 14th amendment and the "acting judge" (whom the sitting judge did not even agree with) granted and ex parte motion for my narcissistic and never employed, welfare recipient, third-time divorced in Henry County with 5 kids, ex-wife. Now LAWO will not [...]

— JASON

The system has destroyed my entire family and when I asked the corrupt judge greer to tell me why, he simply told me he don't have to explain why he made the decision to terminate my rights. Let that sink in....

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



False claims to CPS by my boyfriend's ex girlfriend. Kids were on a safety plan for 2 weeks while I got drug tested and came back negative

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Took my grandson away and gave him to the abusers who then kept him and his siblings from coming home to me

— ROBIN

Because I'm deaf - system use my abuser and his mother as their primary and believe them because they have voice and I don't. They lie a lot about me. Judge refused to see my proof motion. They never on my side. I even show them my proof of abuser hit me and raped me. The judge [...]

— AVRIL

They took away my rights as a mother to raise my children as I see fit. I was always either a stay at home mom or I worked as needed and was forced to work full-time. They took my kids away during the school time, but not during the summer, because I didn't believe in the very [...]

— KAYLEIGH

Linda Kate and Karen Dummermuth destroyed my relationship with my oldest child based on lies and false accusations.

— AMANDA

The system has torn my family apart. Someone who's never met my children gets to be the judge of my parenting. My kids want to come home where they belong. These people ruined my life.

— BRANDY

This system has caused trauma which will last a lifetime, destroyed a beautiful family and proven they are nothing less than a FOR PROFIT Corporation that enriches itself monetarily by destroying children's lives, knowingly, willingly and maliciously with zero accountability!

— LUCIANA

Completely destroyed our bonded and took my son from me and refused his sister's visitation or custody

— REBECCA

The depression and hurt of not being able to a mother to your children is devastating. My children suffered abuse and mental health abuse.

— BELINDA

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



This system has ripped my kids from wverything they knew. They have caused hurt anger and my kids are suffering and lashing out.

— MERSADEES

They traumatized my family and tore our life apart. They stole years of time that I should have been bonding with my baby.

— AMBER

They assigned child support gi ing me 30 days to pay \$12000 in arrearages from my children's birth. I became an instant felon. Lost or denied many jobs over 15 years due to this fact. Spent 7 days in jail. Was forced to sign away right after 2 lawyers took my money and wouldn't [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Allow abusers and a rapist to be around the kids. Not take the kids seriously. Money talks.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Crushed my family, turned my loving kids into having hate in their soul,

— JONATHAN

I struggle daily to keep going I've completed all steps in my life to better myself and my kids were just given less contact with each step I completed! I've lost weight and jobs and homes since losing my girls. I'm down to 100lbs due to stress. All I ever wanted to be when I [...]

— KARI

This system allows legal kidnapping, because there are no checks and balances for Juvenile Court Judges. Judge Kristen Johnson has caused tremendous trauma to not only me and my son but our entire family. Director Randall Galbraith and Supervisor Karmen Lauth intentionally [...]

— JAMES

Dcfs and the gal do not have the best interest of my kids. They are destroying them.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I almost died that day my children were "legally" kidnapped. It will take a lifetime to recover from this.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



Ripped three innocent kids from their loving father who they share a very deep bond with. But we remain - this corrupt system will never defeat our love for each other, ever.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Caused severe emotional distress on both me and my 2 children Caused trauma for my kids as infants being taken and trauma for me as their biological mother

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This court has given my children a lifetime of trauma, stole their childhood, and made them feel like they don't matter.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Because of a medical professional making a false allegation to CPS, it ruined the birth and bonding of my newborn

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

There is nothing but corruption in Highland county Ohio. CPS ignores all reports even from mandated reporters. Detective dismissed all claims of abuse because Dad showed pictures of child playing happy when the report of abuse came from Children's hospital after an evaluation [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

"This system tore our family apart, stripped away our stability, and left us living through years of silence, fear, and unanswered pain while we fought to hold onto hope and each other."

— CORDIO

The system has committed institutional betrayal(freyd) Separation from Gracie and trauma to her from separation and continued psychological abuse. Spousal abuse by the ex. Destroyed my career as an RN. Destroyed my reputation. Gracie developed fight or flight anxiety from [...]

— DARICK

It destroyed my relationship with my son.

— JERRY

This system has destroyed my family to the point I don't think the damage could ever be undone.

— SKYLAR

204 Ohio parents submitted approved, shareable comments. 42 selected excerpts appear here; the full comments begin on the next page.

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS — OHIO

The comments below are the full approved, publicly shareable survey comments from Ohio families. Data-only and do-not-share submissions are excluded from this public appendix.

This CPS and juvenile court system in Scioto County Ohio has destroyed me , my daughter and her 3 children. They failed to provide our family with a full family conference and purposely blocked out the rest of us in order to manipulate my daughter and take her children forever. The process is ongoing yet on the 3d child and 2 others the court recently awarded full custody to the state and parental rights were taken . Now their taking the other daughter. This isnt all though. When my sons girl friend moved out of their home with their 3 mo old baby cps was called back in 2024 over 15 times by the whole community because the baby was being exposed to drug abuse in his face and cps only warned her to go to rehab. After she did for 3 days she left rehab and cps was called again, they did nothing and did not return to save the child and he died 4 days later. That mother is serving time in prison. They failed to protect when a child needed it. But then they forever took 3 other grandchildren of mine when rehabilitation was working and prevention supports would have helped and was helping. My daughter did her time. 6 months in a star program and then currently went to rehab on her own once released for another 90 days. But the courts refused to see that we loved our babies they refused me and blamed my income and I have 4 years of college in Psychology, and criminal justice as well had a CDCA drug counselor certificate and am a mental health peer specialist. But these people ignored those facts and because I wasnt working at the time and was on disability they had the judge deny me to intervene because of my low income and because the worker ignored my calls to get the kids

— ANONYMOUS PARENT (1/3)

when she first got on the case the time line was over and I had no clue to go do anything because I was in full shock . I was and stopped am in disbelief that this happened..They gave me the kids the first 3 days but then snagged them away and used lies and manipulation to do it and they listen to my daughter who was angry at me at first and wanted them moved from me also. But then she changed her mind after her mind became clear and she began to see what was happening. Drugs was not involved in the direct reason they was taken.. the family was napping and the twp boys got up first and went outside and sit-down on their steps..a nosy neighbor who couldn't stand my daughter called in on her. No helping her or the kids to get back inside but called to ruin a family. Kids get out !! Its life! Although its dangerous kids do it all across America and moms are not doubles. We only get one mom. So Scioto County Ohio took the opportunity to gain two special needs children at that and refused kin to have them. .they moved my grandchildren 7 times home to home and they still are moving them. And all along they could be home with grandmother and happy and content. They browk the law and refused us all due process. Violated my daughters privacy and told people In the family my daughter was a monster and that they was taking her kids permanently before they even notified the parents of the children. They have caused me not to sleep for over a year now. I have night mares and I scream out their names in the night begging please dont take my grandchildren. My daughter has night mares and she cries all the time while still pushing herself in her recovery. This cps and family court and

— ANONYMOUS PARENT (2/3)

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

attorneys has caused mental trauma to me my daughter and grandchildren. I saw my grandchildren on FaceTime at the father's visits every Friday and they begged me please mimi come get us and save us. And I have night mares because of it. This was a simple open and shut case and all they had to do was give me the support I needed to get set up with the children and leave us alone My daughter tried to sign me her rights over and the jail notary denied her that right and so did the courts and cps .. They have totally destroyed us and them babies forever and my son and I also have to grieve for his dead son that they could have and should have saved but Didn't. They , the Scioto County Ohio CPS, Police department and Courts failed my family and we will never be the same again.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT (3/3)

I have been stripped of my legal rights and majority parenting time to my children through false allegations of parental alienation and unscrupulous actors in the family court system aiding my abusers to weaponize our children to continue patterns of post separation abuse and coercive control.

— REBECCA

Terminated my Parental Rights in Fraud and destroyed my children.

— PATSY

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

I am living in absolute H 3// right now. My son has a rare genetic disorder and had a bit of an episode that was unusual for him. A traumatic experience triggered him to act out of character and lock me out of my house. The police were called (not by me) and the short of it is they charged him criminally. He just turned 14 and has a 72 IQ. He is kind and has a great personality. Since i was the alleged "victim " of the "crime" i figured it would be easy to get him out of juvenile detention. His attorney, my attorney, we are both fighting to have him freed. The GAL and judge want him to go to an institution!!!! It's insanity, absolute insanity. They had the board of DD and our whole team try to get him placed inpatient. It was denied and the appeal was denied because he isn't remotely even CLOSE to needing that level of care!!! So their genius idea was to have CPS take temporary custody. I absolutely REFUSED. They held a pretend hearing (pretended that it mattered what I wanted or what my son's therapist wanted), granted CPS temporary custody, even THEY can't get him in patient and they're using juvenile detention as a day care. Meanwhile my son has been assaulted THREE TIMES, moved 3 times to different pods, and has been fed dairy every single day even though he is medically allergic to it. We are living in an unbelievable nightmare. There is no end in sight. GAL on the case Ohio Lawyer Suspended From Practice Over Mishandling of Guardianship - Tucson Elder Law Attorney <https://share.google/8YU34sAHXYx1Hbt91> My disabled son cries every day and just wants to come home to his stuffed animals and family. He is being abused and can't comprehend everything. CPS worker lied so

— ANONYMOUS PARENT (1/2)

many times I've lost count. I don't drink, do drugs, I live in a nice suburban area and own my condo.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT (2/2)

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

My health is declined, my traumatic brain injury symptoms that have been managed for over a decade have flared up and I've been exacerbated by CPS involvement and core actors, denying my rights appearance, character assassination by hearsay of those who've never witnessed anything being said, lying on the stage of purging themselves. My doctors are starting to get fed up because the court is not listening to them or submitting their testimonies. My daughter and I were in a really bad car accident five years ago on the way to my oldest son's graduation. We've been in court for the last five years and now because I don't have my daughter this case is being dismissed that attorney is getting mad saying that he can't move forward if I don't have my daughter because she was another one of the witnesses and it gets out that I don't have my child it'll be considered that I'm a bad mom so therefore he's dismissed this case I will get no closure over a car accident that left me with no memory of my first born's child's graduation party that I planned. The mental emotional physical and spiritual stress that this has caused myself in my family and the false allegations that will never be found to be true, has impacted our lives greatly.. our family friends Dr School they all know the truth, but keeping my child away from me medically neglecting her, not getting her to mental health has caused me to over. Worry about my daughter, putting my health at risk caused me a silent heart attack in November complex, migraines, and stroke like symptoms. I ended up G.I. bleeding internally had to have a colonoscopy because it couldn't figure out what was causing the bleeding since CPS got

— ANONYMOUS PARENT (1/3)

involved I end up with a perforated colon was in the hospital for five days in critical care almost died because of the stress and an officer that it's caused all because CPS is hell bound on destroying a family trying to make me go insane the harder I fight the more I proved their lies the more they're keeping my daughter from me and this is affecting my daughter mentally and emotionally. I know it is they're telling her that her family and friends doesn't want to see Her. Alienating her from her loved ones from medical care team, a failing, her friends, especially her siblings. They had a super tight bond and now her brothers are so upset at this entire situation and the lies that have been said about our family that strong family bond has been severed . They're telling her all kinds of lies and my daughter starting to believe it. My daughter doesn't even know what's happening on this side. They're not allowing us to talk. We can't reconcile because we can't talk about what is happened. They tell me to move on, but I can't get closure.. I'm worried that my daughter's health she's gonna go back and start having flareups and her body's gonna start falling apart all the work in progress that my daughter has had over the last four years they've stopped all of her care not taking her to her Specialist taking her to those outside of Children's providers who do not know about my daughter's medical history. I fear for my daughter's life and her safety and my daughter doesn't understand what's going on with her body. She believes these individuals who know nothing about her or her medical complexities. This is literally killing me. My doctors have told me that if I don't stop

— ANONYMOUS PARENT (2/3)

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

fighting there won't be a left for my daughter to come home too. I've had two cardiac events as well. I was also in back restrictions in November. I'm having two major back surgeries in August. I was made to walk up and down the stairs. I re-injured my back and became paralyzed at Court November 4 spent two days in the hospital then.. after G.I. bleeding from an ulcer due to CPS is involvement and not doing their jobs another court date January 23 I bought time I got home. I was disoriented lost a lot of blood fell and hit my head became unresponsive. My oxygen witness 60s and I almost died. I was innovated in the hospital for two days fighting for my life. My health is declined the harder I fight for just the harder I fight for my daughter, the bigger toll what's playing on my heart and my body.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT (3/3)

Took my 4 children from a mother they all 4 testified to stay with in an in-camera interview-to retaliate, the court covered it up as MOOT and said I coached OLDER TEENAGERS and SEALED THE DOCKET to cover it up. They allow dad to get away with murder while forcing me to take punishments for lies and false allegations that have never been proven! Dad has a DV record and a diagnosed personality disorder and allowed him to commit felonies while I remain childless. This is damaging my kids and confusing them. It is beyond criminal and illegal! Thank God for appeals but this judge purposely withholds cases so they don't go to appellate court!

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

As a Honorable Veteran, I have witnessed a pattern of corruption and abuse of power in this system concerning my children and I for years. This system has continuously cycled trauma with no relief for victims.

— AUDREY

This system has failed myself and my children and placed all 6 children with the abuser! The GAL on my case didn't even protect them the didn't do her full investigation/job , job and family services CPS WORKER ASHELY STACY LIED ON STANDS AND LIED AND SAID MY CHILDREN SAID STUFF THEY NEVER SAID! She along with father coached my children also. The judge never heard me or my side she didn't care to and that's just not right either she is bias and committed treason!

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

It has destroyed us and wreaked havoc on our family. My son was prematurely ripped from his primary caregiver at 2 years of age to be given to a father who was more like a stranger since he was so uninvolved in his son's life prior to retaining a lawyer. The system has failed to provide protective measures for my son despite my evidence, his disclosures and our pleas for safety. They have prioritized parental rights over safety for my child and have forced contact between the two of us despite the domestic violence history, ex- parte CPO and years of abuse. It's criminal how this system treats protective mothers and their vulnerable children.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The American dream is dead, enslaved by corrupt systems that steal our children. Abiding not, by the maternal rights inherently established by God; Creator of the Universe.

— AIMEE

The system did the opposite of what it was supposed to do. It destroyed my family, damaged my children, caused irreversible harm to our relationships, and long-term trauma for us all to continue to deal with.

— KEITH

They only had my kids for a month but kept custody for a year. My children were so traumatized that they were changed for life. It is a demonic spirit, the spirit of decision. I am sorry

— PATRICIA

High conflict custody with abuse mentality emotionally Gal reports in favor and made recommendations judge still won't do anything.

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06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

The system has violated my 14th amendment and the “acting judge” (whom the sitting judge did not even agree with) granted and ex parte motion for my narcissistic and never employed, welfare recipient, third-time divorced in Henry County with 5 kids, ex-wife. Now LAWO will not work with us in any case, because of a conflict of interest. Napoleon police, when I left my ex-wife, told me that they didn’t believe me when I reported domestic abuse to them. Napoleon police continued to work in favor of my ex-wife, (who shares a bedroom with my daughter in low income housing), when we questioned my daughter’s well being, and never allowed us to send CPS to interview my ex. It is a circus down there.

— JASON

The system has destroyed my entire family and when I asked the corrupt judge greer to tell me why, he simply told me he don't have to explain why he made the decision to terminate my rights. Let that sink in....

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

False claims to CPS by my boyfriend’s ex girlfriend. Kids were on a safety plan for 2 weeks while I got drug tested and came back negative

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Took my grandson away and gave him to the abusers who then kept him and his siblings from coming home to me

— ROBIN

Because I’m deaf - system use my abuser and his mother as their primary and believe them because they have voice and I don’t. They lie a lot about me. Judge refused to see my proof motion. They never on my side. I even show them my proof of abuser hit me and raped me. The judge said I’m a bad mother because of interpreter - like serious? I need correct interpreter for my language rights. They put my abuser as 100 kid custody and gave me a hard time! I didn’t see my kids for two years!

— AVRIL

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

They took away my rights as a mother to raise my children as I see fit. I was always either a stay at home mom or I worked as needed and was forced to work full-time. They took my kids away during the school time, but not during the summer, because I didn't believe in the very young children being in sports on Sunday as it is our only day together as a family. My ex-husband believed not vaccinating our children when they were young and used it against me to gain full custody and full medical over me. I was forced to pay child support to him even though he makes \$80,000 a year I make 20,000 and has taken away from the kids when they are here.

— KAYLEIGH

Linda Kate and Karen Dummermuth destroyed my relationship with my oldest child based on lies and false accusations.

— AMANDA

The system has torn my family apart. Someone who's never met my children gets to be the judge of my parenting. My kids want to come home where they belong. These people ruined my life.

— BRANDY

This system has caused trauma which will last a lifetime, destroyed a beautiful family and proven they are nothing less than a FOR PROFIT Corporation that enriches itself monetarily by destroying children's lives, knowingly, willingly and maliciously with zero accountability!

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Completely destroyed our bonded an took my son from me an refused his sister's visitation or custody

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06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

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— MERSADEES

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Allow abusers and a rapist to be around the kids. Not take the kids seriously. Money talks.

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Crushed my family, turned my loving kids into having hate in their soul,

— JONATHAN

I struggle daily to keep going I've completed all steps in my life to better myself and my kids were just given less contact with each step I completed! I've lost weight and jobs and homes since losing my girls. I'm down to 100lbs due to stress. All I ever wanted to be when I grew up out of foster care was the best mom and I know I was with everything in me! I still am I will never stop fighting for my girls back! They was kidnapped on a weekend by Cps! I was diagnosed with postpartum when they took my newborn!

— KARI

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

This system allows legal kidnapping, because there are no checks and balances for Juvenile Court Judges. Judge Kristen Johnson has caused tremendous trauma to not only me and my son but our entire family. Director Randall Galbraith and Supervisor Karmen Lauth intentionally delayed the process of developing a caseplan for me to obtain custody. Then lied under oath about my contact with the agency

— JAMES

Dcfs and the gal do not have the best interest of my kids. They are destroying them.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I almost died that day my children were "legally" kidnapped. It will take a lifetime to recover from this.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Ripped three innocent kids from their loving father who they share a very deep bond with. But we remain - this corrupt system will never defeat our love for each other, ever.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Caused severe emotional distress on both me and my 2 children Caused trauma for my kids as infants being taken and trauma for me as their biological mother

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This court has given my children a lifetime of trauma, stole their childhood, and made them feel like they don't matter.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Because of a medical professional making a false allegation to CPS, it ruined the birth and bonding of my newborn

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06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

There is nothing but corruption in Highland county Ohio. CPS ignores all reports even from mandated reporters. Detective dismissed all claims of abuse because Dad showed pictures of child playing happy when the report of abuse came from Children's hospital after an evaluation and Dads violence history.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

"This system tore our family apart, stripped away our stability, and left us living through years of silence, fear, and unanswered pain while we fought to hold onto hope and each other."

— CORDIO

The system has committed institutional betrayal(freyd) Separation from Gracie and trauma to her from separation and continued psychological abuse. Spousal abuse by the ex. Destroyed my career as an RN. Destroyed my reputation. Gracie developed fight or flight anxiety from psychological abuse by a bpd parent through shame blame guilt intermittent reinforcement broken promises. Destroyed my mental stability i now have cptsd, trauma depression and anxiety. destroyed gracie s relationship with family. gracie has depression. Separated gracie from her chickens and dog jack. She isnt allowed to talk about dad or mom will be really angry and will take things away from her. Gracie was forced to move schools at age 8 in concrete operations stage and leave her friends of 5 years to benefit her mom not the child

— DARICK

It destroyed my relationship with my son.

— JERRY

This system has destroyed my family to the point I don't think the damage could ever be undone.

— SKYLAR

The system has DESTROYED my whole family we had a living family full of MEDICAL PROFESSIONALS and a retired Police Chief- none of us are able to get kinship!!! Children have been traumatized by the state and NEVER WERE. THEY WERE HAPPY, HEALTHY, & THRIVING.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

It cost me my entire life. Caused my kids to have ptsd and trust issues with law enforcement. They where scared to go to school because they lied to my oldest son to take him from the school. This has caused trauma and we are 6 years free from them and still live in fear

— DAWN

Completely changed my life for the worst, destroyed my family and I will never be same person again and my family will never be the same

— VICKI

The person with the most money gets what they want by wearing down this judge and hiring unethical attorneys. Documented abuse over 6+ years is ignored and judge says maybe less restrictions on him will make things better.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Financially destroyed my family and interrupted the bond between my daughter and I including extended family members.

— LEIANNE

Destroyed and scared permanent damage

— SHERROD

Court systems has no integrity and most of all have hurt children and even children have died, they abuse their power and authority.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Destroyed my life and my purpose for living.

— ASHLEY

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

My daughter gave up all rights to my grandson Levi. He has ADHD and behavior disorders. The Judge ruled that if the parents lose all rights to their children, the grandparents do also. This is so unfair and heartbreaking. Child services never even contacted me to see if I could have custody. They just took him and I have no idea how he is or how he is doing.

— ROSE

This system has ripped our once very close family apart. It has done emotional damage to all 6 of my grandkids and severed relationships between my grandkids.

— SHARON

Have taken all 4 children from a loving 2 parent household over false allegations, false evidence, and false testimony given by caseworkers. The GAL Donovan Hill is awful and also gives false testimony. We Haven't seen our children in 2 years.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Falsely accused us of abuse and tore our family apart

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Kids taken without hearing. Zero evidence of abuse or neglect. When I responded and called them all out on Facebook I was punished with jail time and more lost time with my children. My ex and my ex boss got together and turned my posts into my coal mining job for 12 years I was fired. Was sent into a very deep depression. Lost my health insurance so I couldn't afford my anti anxiety meds.

— NICK

Shattered the relationship with son, destroyed my son's image of me, his self esteem, his identity, placed him in the home with the abuser.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Illegal alien with a conviction of sexual abuse of a child was given full custody of a minor child. Parental (entire maternal family) alienation has been endorsed by family court.

— ROBYN

This system stole all 5 of my son's children from our ENTIRE family. Even though I had 2 of these kids as an emergency placement, and kinship placement of my nephew, these children have been kept from the entire paternal side.

— ROBYN

I have been grieving my kids that are STILL ALIVE because of the Clark county ohio family court!! LOST MEMORIES, LOST TIMES, AND A BONDS STOLEN . just like that....gone I LOVE YOU JULIUS AND BRYLON

— BRIANNA

An assistant prosecuting attorney acting as a civil custody lawyer al fight and suppressed a 25 year violent criminal history for his private client. Attorneys judges, GALCPS and even neighboring counties are working together, not in the best interest of the child, but in the best interest of themselves.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

I cry every day, it was always me and my son, every day since he was born, I look at the pictures of me and him together my son clinging onto me when he was little and I break down and cry, we used to order pizza and have pizza and movie night once a month, I taught my son how to cook and we would make dinner together and have dinner and movie night and sit and talk about anything and everything, my son is my whole world, my everything, the family court system and CPS gave my son to the father who was never around and thousands of dollars behind in back child support, I did everything on my own (with help of my grandparent's, aunt and uncle who raised me) but mostly it was always me as the full time parent 24/7 every day for 13 close to 14 years, my son was always in perfect health, had everything he ever wanted and needed, I provided everything, I made sure he always had an education and went to the doctor, when we both got COVID I still took care of my son even though I myself was sick, because mom's don't get sick days, I even offered to give up child support since that was the reason my ex wanted custody, I only want my son, he's my baby, he will always be my baby, now all I have left is pictures and memories and so much hurt and pain, all because of pictures of MY private bedroom being messy taken without my knowledge or consent and sent to CPS, and because CPS and a police officer entered my home without a court order by means of a threat and CPS took my son away on a cold December night, CPS even made my son stand outside in the freezing temperatures for close to an hour they wouldn't even allow my son to go inside where it was warm, and while he was at the "group

— ANONYMOUS PARENT (1/4)

home" CASA and CPS told my son inappropriate things regarding my friends private medical, my ex (his father) told my son "I'm a wh*re" when I'm a strict Christian with strong Christian beliefs, I remember a time my longtime best friend from school gave me a ride to pick up my son for the weekend while he was in state/county care and the caseworker called and demanded that I return my son because my friend and her husband needed to be "CPS approved" (fingerprint and BCI background and drug tested" in order to drive me to pick up my son, and my friend and her husband don't even smoke cigarettes !! This has not only affected me but it also affected my son, the group home made my son push mow a field all summer in the hot sun even on heat advisory days with an infected ingrown toenail while my son was limping in pain, and one foster home was ate up with bed bugs and my son had bug bites all over him, my son said they made him sleep on a bed bugs infested bed with only one sheet and one pillow, now my son is living in a one room apartment shared with 3 other people, no bedroom, a messy apartment, and with his father who never was around or had a part in raising him, my son is angry and hurt, and so am I, laws need to change, unless a house is a hoarding situation they should leave a simple messy house alone, because now both me and my child was extremely hurt, a one happy home completely ripped apart, a child being ripped away from the only parent he ever had, so much hurt was caused by CPS, CASA, Family Court, and the so called public pretender, the more people speak up, the more attention gets drawn, and hopefully lawmakers will change the laws, but that requires the states

— ANONYMOUS PARENT (2/4)

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

governor (in my case Ohio) to actually care, I've called the governor, state representatives, ombudsman, and nothing happened, nobody cared, and if the caseworker knew I spoke up who knows what retaliation would happen, since the court put a "gag-order" on me !! They don't want parents to speak up, because how dare the parents fight back !! Every CPS case NEEDS to be reopened and investigated by the higher courts because there are so many innocent and good parents who have had their child/children taken for the most ridiculous reasons, Clermont County Ohio is always in the spotlight for bad things, they take children from good home and place them in horrible situations, one caseworker told me he was due to remove 10 different children from different homes all in one day, and that speaks volumes, the caseworker (at the time) told me "there are so many kid's in the system in this county they don't have enough homes to place them" and that's why my son was sent three or four counties away !! It's time that every parent speak up and tell their stories, because if not this will keep happening !! We all need to get up and take a stand, I have not been the same emotionally since my son was taken, my heart is so broken, I just want my son back in my arms, Supreme Court NEEDS to do something to fix what COS and family court is doing, they cause more harm than good, and it will keep happening if laws are not changed, look up Clermont County Ohio CPS, they are known for shady stuff and targeting innocent parents more so single mom's, if I could afford a paid lawyer my case would have been won easily, but due to disability and disability income I couldn't afford one, and they sure

— ANONYMOUS PARENT (3/4)

had no problem holding disability against me, I might be disabled but I'm not incompetent to where I can't be a mom, after all I was a mom for 13 years, and I have the documents to show it, I save everything, I have a treasure trove of documents I'm willing to share !!

— ANONYMOUS PARENT (4/4)

Removed my kids to ex parte without letting my attorney know.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Took away our entire lives. Completely destroyed our mental health. Made my children believe I'm the bad guy and don't love them or care about them. Told them I wasn't their mother and their father wasn't their father.

— ALEXANDREA

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Allowed this person to commit criminal crimes against me by not allowing me to see my children and has gotten away with every single one.

— SARA

This system has caused a ginormous splinter in the bond I hold with my children. Refused and erased my ancestral traditions and our way of life.

— RAVEN

took my daughter who was sexually abused, and put her back with her abuser in the same home the abuse occurred. she then got molested again in under a month of contact

— HEIDI

It has caused severe trauma for both of us. My daughter is not getting the medical care she needs, and I worry about her safety everyday. My daughter already had anxiety prior to separation. they destroyed our bond and all the good things ive done her whole life.

— HEATHER

The system has single-handedly divided and destroyed my sense of security, my sense of peace, my children from my life and allowed the abuser to publicly look like a hero, forcing the mother to pay a child support for two kids while residing in Ohio and kids being in California and I haven't seen my kids since before Covid

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system has been totally used against me and has completely destroyed my relationship with my son

— VINCENT

It has broken me. I have lost hope in any system set in place to protect children from abuse. There are not enough words to express the pain I carry from this experience. The only reason I'm still fighting is because of my girls.

— WHITNEY

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Family Court is the battlefield of psychological warfare. They are causing lifetime traumas with no accountability or oversight!

— RENEE

Violated my civil rights as a parent, told multiple lies of omission, threatened my status as a parent by COERCION

— ADETRIA YOUR WORST

They have caused so much emotional and mental trauma. They have taken away time we can never get back and trauma we can never fix.

— FLORENCE

A judge who put me in foster care should have NEVER overseen my case!

— ANASTASIA

I had nightmares and night terrors that I was medicated for. Noone believed me. CPS wouldn't lie to take a child. I was ostracized. I was alienated from all of my grandkids because of this. I now struggle with cptsd and basically a recluse. I have nothing left.

— MICHELE

It impacted me seriously in my life and my family severely. No amount of money will ever filled the lost. The system failed. The judge failed. Our family is heartbroken of the corruption in court would not allow evidence and not enough time to prove it.. the judge and Attorney had involvement together and talking about cases and meeting each other in restaurants.

— JOANNA

I am one of five stories in my group of friends that has had the same treatment by this Trumbull County, Warren, Ohio court system. All of the men I know have been disrespected and their parenting time stolen in addition to attorney fees, and child support for mothers that have only negative influence over their children.

— NATHAN

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

This has made me lose faith in a system I thought I could trust and I honestly thought they would protect us how wrong was I they did the opposite they ripped my kids from a Loving beautiful family and Home my grandmother died of a broken heart from missing our children and by the grace of GOD I am still here I no longer believe in the system but do believe in God and I know he's gonna turn this system on its head and shake it out and restore the families that have been wrongfully separated I do believe this will be the case that. Will not makeup for the time and the milestones missed but it will stop this from happening to future families

— MARY

I'm not in the good ole boys and girls club. Ex wife, her husband, lawyer, judge and child support are.

— CHRISTOPHER

Created litigation abuse, DARVO, violates the constitution land of law, me allowing to speak, violation of due process.

— JESSICA

The system falsely accused my fiancé, and then even after her charge have been dismissed. I am now still being punished years later.

— RACHEL

They destroyed our confidence and consistency. They destroyed my child's mental health and mine. They did nothing but lie to help make that happen.

— ANNA

Butler and warren county ohio destroyed my family and took time I will never get back

— JESSICA

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

It has caused further trauma, cause children to cry out for help and be denied so they turn to committing crimes as thats what they are being taught instead of protected. It tears apart siblings and grandparents and great grandparents.

— CATHERINE

Despite having a protection order and evidence of abuse and coercive control and opposing party not following any court orders (psych evaluation and hair strand test) and having multiple contempts of court, the GAL is suggesting joint custody.

— EMILY

The courts didn't just take my rights — they took my child, my time, my voice, my safety, and the chance to protect the one person who depended on me to survive.

— TACI

It has cost me a lot of money and emotional abuse from this court. It was unfair and I was treated unfairly because of who my ex husbands mother is. The gal was bias and completely unfair in my case I believe because of my ex mother in law being a mayor in the same county I had to go to court. My ex had also lied on me about things and my evidence was presented to my attorney and ignored. My family who came with me to this court was also treated rudely and I was told they should have not been in the building. This was in Miami county Ohio.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This system has stripped the joy of parenting and the free time we would use to have a better life. The money needed to do things drained by these leaches in suits!

— GARY

My driver's license/ID has came up missing and I've had my apartment broken into in the past. False documents have also been placed in my apartment.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

It gave my child PTSD and denied her rights to be safe from actual proven physical harm done to her.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It's cost me my relationship with my kids father, strain on my mental health everything

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system has gaslighted my children just as their abuser has, dismissed abuse repeatedly to the point of betrayal, and minimized the years of single parenting under coercive control I have survived. The court has belittled my children and I in the most damaging ways.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Always favors mother - Ignores her contempt - takes my time away from Me but not her - never gives make up time - allows mother to withhold children - doesn't assign proper GaL that can't handle high conflict cases

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Has alienated me from my child. Destroyed the relationship my child and I had.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Ripped apart what was a great family because of pure ignorance and bias

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I want to see them all burn in hell. If I ever get the chance to fully tell my story, this is when I'll give the most impactful statement.

— JENNIFER

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

The court system has destroyed my family, the relationship with my son and his brothers. They have walked all over my constitutional rights to parent my child.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system ripped my family apart. Broke our unity, our circle, caused major anxiety problems, behavior issues and cost the respect my oldest son had for me. He idolized me and now he doesn't respect me, he has been brainwashed by the system and his father whom they gave full custody to because of this last wrongful accusation. Has caused me so much emotional guilt and pain from not having my children with me, the pain of having your infants taken from your arms is the worst pain a mother can have. My children have separation issues and I have major PTSD even from the door being knocked on. It has destroyed our family.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Tore my family apart is currently still causing PTSD pain sadness my kids are brainwashed anxiety depression stresses

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Taken my kids from loving parents and grandparents

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Fraud. My child is a shell of themselves.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Destroyed my family, eroded the finances, dragged on three years, children in Civil war against each other and alienation of Parents. Children's relationship with Parents forever destroyed.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Lost time and crucial relationship with my kids and has destroyed my reputation with anyone in this town or County and made me lose a job due to the pressure

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Disregard best interest of child, and but child back in abusive homes to allow her to be abused again.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Torn apart a mom from her kids and alienated a mom for 4+ years while a sex offender has had access to them Broken a mamas heart day in and day out

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Removed valuable time with my children and broken their mental health and mine, caused more problems than i had in the abusive marriage

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Took my only opportunity to raise my children the way I wanted. Didn't allow me to protect my children from evil. Put my children and myself into a domestic court ordered situation.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Ripped apart my entire family in the name of business for the boys club.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I lost everything fighting for my son, I had my rights taken from me and I was only able to see him for a short time each week, they put me in such a financial situation that it cause permanent brain damage due to the stress and forced labor due to threat of arrest from child support. Now I'm unable to work or do the things I would like, and I feel they I will never get back the health that this court has taken away from me.

— JAYDE

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

I am the grandmother trying to get kinship, visitation, custody intervention and was denied. All family were denied kinship without background checks or home studies. the agency oushes everyone INTO COURT. Our backgrounds include medical which means we have nothing in our backgrounds, a foster family that includes retired pikice chief and a director of nursing, and i al a Licensed Medical Massage therapist and have hosted 6 foreign exchange students exchange students, which means deeply vetted. The system is keeping kids systemically in this county for profit. The childrens regression has been blamed on their mother and shes never been anything but a good mother. It has ruined our entire family.

— JAMIE

Placed child in an unsafe situation causing mental, emotional, and physical abuse to child.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It has you destroyed my family and destroyed his kids their babies and they're scared about every time they turn around they're going to be took the bedroom

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system has drained my spirit and injured my sense of hope and morality. It has created a wedge between myself and my children that need never be there - it has left me unprotected, vulnerable, and battered. I am disappointed, discouraged, and angry. I miss my kids.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I was extorted by the courts by way of litigation abuse

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Mentally and emotionally (all professionally documented (IOP, counselor, psychiatrist) deabiltated. If you need documentation it is all there

— ROBIN

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Took my entire life, my motherhood, my job, my car, my home, my safety and security, my trust in the system, my wellbeing. Most importantly my three daughters childhoods, innocence, and child parent relationship.

— MARISSA

They do not do anything for interference of custody. No consequences so far this will be his second

— EMILY

I moved to a different state after my kids were taken. I went from a successful career driven single mother to an unemployed, homeless woman in full blown active addiction where I am currently.

— AMBER

Has taken everything i had purpose to live for

— AMANDA

Destoryed everthing i built and handed it to the person who abandon us for years.

— MEGAN

My child was taken at birth without any allegations of abuse or neglect, based solely on a past case, and I have been left without clear reunification steps while being limited to minimal visitation.”

— JUSTIN

“Truth doesn’t panic when it’s questioned. Stay patient—what’s real has a way of rising to the surface.”

— MOLLY

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Cps has done so much pain for my family that I cant get back 2 years

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Took my kids out of a loving home to place them where ever they could following all the recommendations they set to have unsupervised visits so we can move on to overnight and then home but I never one time got more parenting time or any of the unsupervised visits or overnight. The GAL didn't do his report and was still allowed on the case and much much more.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system has completely broke us and failed us. Out of all the people that I know in our county it has lost their children to the system. I am the only one that was able to get mine back..

— MATTALYNN

“This system drained our family emotionally and financially, forcing us to spend everything we had just to be heard, while separating us from our children without timely answers or accountability. It turned protection into punishment and survival into a constant fight.”

— BRITNEY

Took phone calls away my visits ect please call I have so much to say

— TRISHA

The court process has turned what should have been a child-focused custody matter into years of instability, forced separation, and emotional strain on my children and me. The lack of accountability has caused lasting harm to our family relationships

— ANNA

My family has turned their back on each other has broken sibling bonds and made some of my kids rebel agaist the system and caused ttust issues against the system

— ANDREA

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Violated my rights kidnapped my child and used her estate as leverage of extortion in commerce against me using a fictitious scarecrow and tricking me into their jurisdiction to be used in commerce as a current day slave.

— HARLEY

This systemic issue in Hancock county unjustly kept the children from all relatives to break bonds. They ignored phone calls and requests. They ignore ombudsman recommendations. They denied kinship with no written denials. We have missed every milestone and holidays over the past almost 2 years. It has caused many family issues. During this time Kelli tried to stop us from being licensed fosters and said we will not get these children to our first home study worker. We became licensed in July 2025. We have had several children placed with us but still requests for kinship of the children have been ignored. She cut and paste a court document and said this is why and sent it in an email. We have never been in court. We currently have a foster child that we have had placed in our home county for almost 10 months. Please make it make sense. It's about abuse of power, retaliation, abuse of funding and just pure evil. The children have been traumatized more being in foster care than had then been placed other loving family. They never did a Kinnect case.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system has created a tear in our family that will never fully heal. They took an allegation and without proper investigation created a false narrative that rewrote my daughters childhood.

— AARON

Complete destroyed us my daughters are in my life we are trying to get their brother home his GAL is who has him lied said he was adopted as well to his sister's they asked her about the childsupport an she freaked out stopped all contact he will be 12 this year jayden joe alexander lopez ERIKA CERVI HAS MY SON

— REBECCA

They took the happiest and joy out of us

— JENNIFER

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Ignorance was bliss & a privilege. Psychological & spiritual warfare. Indescribable suffering for profit, power & control at the expense of immeasurable psychological & emotional damage to my children, myself...our family unit.

— JODI

Destroyed my family, heightened my depression and has used my military service against me. Is mentally destroying my children who have now been diagnosed severely depressed with adjustment behavior disorder. And placed my children in an abusive, toxic home 24/7 as bruises and wounds have been documented but ignored.

— GLEN

Union County Domestic Relations Court, Union County Sheriff's Department and Union County Juvenile Court have partnered to fleece me of all of my assets, destroy any stability I may have been able to provide for the future, and consistently facilitates the deterioration of my child's health and well-being at the hands of my abusive Coparent. This system has tried to deploy every possible covert custody stealing gambit into my case except for Union County CPS, which is complicit by turning a blind eye to multiple reports of abuse in the other home. This concerted effort has been happening for several years, and I have no doubt it won't end until my child turns 18 or one of us takes our last breath, whichever comes first.

— JESSICA

Caused so much trauma and left us in a hole almost impossible to get out of and with destruction waiting at the top when we do. And my babies will be permanently and for a lifetime affected by decisions and not investigations. For money and not protection. They made it impossible for Me to ever be the mom I dreamed of being and broke the mom I was-I live in fear of needing to ever protect my children-all because I told it was safe to ask them for help and they would help me and my babies.

— TALISHA

Completely ruined my life and changed the outcome of my daughters life.

— JENNIFER

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

My son wasn't abused — he was acting out at his dad's house because he was desperate for his father's attention. Instead of listening to the truth, the system blamed me, twisted his pain into something it wasn't, and handed my child to the very parent who was barely there for him

— ALYSSA

Took away two loving active present parents from 4 little ones we made our own tight nit little family with. Destroyed our family mentally emotionally and physically.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Abusing my daughter Tasheen every moment.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This system has caused me to have extreme anxiety. 2 heart attacks. Open heart surgery, psych evals. Anger issues.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

I have lost any real hope that the system is there to help. I have lost so much time with my daughters. It's something if I think about it honestly wanna die. It has made me so depressed. It's hard to function some days but I do because my husband now deserves a wife and someone there you know for him too while he helps me so much that helps my daughters. I've missed fourth and fifth grade. I've missed birthdays. I'm going to be missing their 10th being alienated and knowing that stories are being filled in their minds is something that's truly upsetting and I really wish people didn't just follow the money in the courts. I wish they cared and I believe that everyone that's in the family court should also be a licensed psychologist they should have the knowledge in the war with all before they make determining factors that have long time emotional effects you know all this is extremely damaging, psychologically, and it also affects my daughter's bodies with gaining weight or not gaining weight, you know anxiety and it's affected their schoolwork. It's affected their belief in me and I'm having a really hard time coparenting with someone who is so dead set on, hurting me and using the kids constantly to do so and I just wish you know along the way my lawyers didn't put me into this position. You know, I've had many lawyers. I'm on my fifth set but all along the way they they've guided me in directions that I've only actually made it worse so everyone's friends everyone knows everyone I had to go to Canton to find lawyers that were not friends and friendly with Kyoga County courts and so far that has been making a little bit of a difference however, the court cost keep

— ANONYMOUS PARENT (1/2)

getting racked up because the courts keep allowing ex-husband's lawyer to push and change things and they are just granted and it's just a game and the only ones that are suffering are my daughters and I mean I am too but their little kids so it's real and these court systems are corrupt and family court is domestic relations is awful

— ANONYMOUS PARENT (2/2)

Prepare for court for 2 full days prior. Day of court, judge did not want to see us. Pushed for settlement. Judge left while we were still attempting to settle. Did divorce by zoom.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Family court has taken a child from her mother and has taken all rights from the mother so she cannot raise her own child; done by force, without compliance, without reason. Family court is the opposite of what is good. It's harmful, callous, malicious, unlawful, and evil. We the people must protect our children from family court.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

System is slow to process my divorce case. Opposing attorney is war mongering. My initial attorney fear mongered and worked with opposing counsel against me.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It has traumatized an innocent child and mother and forced child back into dangerous situation with father a career criminal. The child was ripped away from safe mother due to perjury, due process and unlawfully court kidnapping. These people are monsters who will go to any extent to use child as a weapon.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Almost five year case, judge ignored all evidence and it has affected my child ever since. Father is so high conflict I live in fear and chaos almost daily.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I've lost my son and my identity as his mother over false allegations of mental illness when i have zero addictions nor abuse documented and had full custody for 10 years. I remain stuck in supervised visits with no agreement or plan for reunification. Opposing counsel states the child is doing so much better since the removal of his mother. When the psychiatrist diagnosed him with depression related to loss of contact with his mother.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Drained me financially and destroying my relationship with my child one violation at a time with no consequences

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Highland County is corrupt and has their minds made up before court even takes place. i've lost three years on my sons life, growth, milestones and a bond for all that time.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Cost me my child. I can never get back the time I lost.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

They have stolen year's that I will never get back over a lie because someone called and said my son was crying yeah baby's cry they adopted my oldest son out and their trying to do the same thing with my youngest son..

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

there are no words that can adequately describe what the system has cost us.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They opened our eyes, and strengthened out defenses.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They have ruined my faith in the courts and them doing what's right . My whole life has been altered , mentally, physically and spiritually. It changes you completely

— ROBERT

Cause me to have medical disability alienate my on son

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Denied motion and ignored evidence!! None of them did their job they made up everything. The judge didn't want to listen to us whatsoever that we gave him evidence and they didn't show him any evidence and that he ruled with them over us. He delayed hearings gave them more time biased, he didn't sign half of his records he had to click record sign it things like that you can put well. She really really wasn't on our case that much it was mainly James he was the one he was his assistant prosecutor. They have kept me away from my daughter since she was born. Have false documents and have been proven but no one will listen to me. Please help me!!!!

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I am on depression and anxiety pills my dad had full blown pneumonia and heart problems from stress

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

This system has lied and tore my family apart causing emotional damage

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

My lived experience that is still ongoing has cast me into homelessness, taken all my belongings and created a situation that is impossible to regain stability even at its simplest form, and has attempted to silence my and my children's stories from not just being heard but from the record entirely; it has cost me the most precious and valuable thing of all, my children, as well as my and my children's protection, belief in justice, safety, healing, my children's voices and their childhood at ages 7 & 11.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They have took everything from me, I have missed so many things and lost what means more to me than anything...my babies

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It is the storm I can't get out of. It suffocates me daily.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

by ignoring evidence, they allowed my child to be molested again.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

A corrupt system doesn't fear evil, they already possess that, it fears witnesses.. of which my family and I have been and well documented our experiences during the months and months I filed every motion and in sept of 2024 was granted the compel to care order against the Tuscarawas JFS.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Took our health, finances and entrapped us into never ending horrific cycles of abuse. It gaslit us and turned every good thing about parenting and our bonds into a "problem". It's an upside down land that makes you fight everyday to hold onto reality.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

The system has done nothing for me except bring stress

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

EX and GAL accused me of being a drug (narcotic) addict during a high conflict divorce WITHOUT ANY EVIDENCE, and used my PTSD from my time in the military as the "cause". Because of my PTSD being affected but this, I agreed to full custody to my ex so a technicality of losing my kids due to my non-existent drug addiction wasn't present.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Seeing a child you love suffering s pure torture

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

“When they couldn’t use the original accusations they had to come after my mental health”

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The "family" court of Athens County, Ohio was effectively used as a shield and sword in my ex-wife's crusade to liquidate my life and crush my soul.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Created hostility and total alienation of all parties involved

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Despite absolutely stealing my children, the system has worked feverishly to ruin my career, evict me from my home, turn friends against me, ruin my reputation, put me in prison, and bankrupt me all to get me to give up, take a plea and walk away. Acting in the best interest of the kids is a fallacy —because the goal was never “justice for the kids,” it was to weaponize compliance.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

I spent 25 plus years living in an abusive, unsupportive and neglectful marriage. The family court system is equally abusive, unsupportive and neglectful. There is no “justice” in our justice system. The priorities of the court is for profit - not “for the people”.. (I wish I could speak to someone directly as my case has been very unique since the opposition was a former sheriff. I was told at one point I could not even file for a protection order because it was a conflict of interest and I wouldn’t have a judge to sign it). Criminal investigations were pushed off to the state and severely delayed or ignored) my children are no longer minors. It was not safe for me to leave while he was sheriff as he threatened to use the system against me the entire time. I had no where to turn.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Failed to protect a 3 yr old and openly fed her to a monster pedophile and created lifelong trauma and forced us to live in the hood I was a stay at home mom for over 2 yrs cut off funds, removed me. From home

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system is an absolute disgrace, it’s ruined my children’s lives and my life. The system is a child trafficking ring - children go to the highest bidder.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They took everything from us, they literally tried to murder us, but we’re still standing. Anyone that obsessed with controlling another person needs to be institutionalized.

— NICOLE

I lost all respect for the justice system. I am afraid to speak up because its so clear how deeply this evil goes.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Financial devastation. Emotionally crippled

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

20 years of marriage and 5 children, This system has completely torn my family apart. I never anticipated that thru my divorce I would lose my children. After being their sole caretaker throughout the duration of my marriage and for their whole lives I now have all my children together with me for a total of 5 hours once a month.

— BRIGETTE

This system did not simply mishandle a case—it destabilized my family, punished me for surviving, and gave more weight to control and paperwork than to truth, safety, and healing. What it cost us cannot be measured only in money or court dates; it cost my children peace, stability, and precious time with the mother who has never stopped fighting for them.

— TOSHIA

The judge said there was no evidence I ever directly harmed my child, and I still only get six hours on Sunday — six hours to hold her, to be her mom, to feel normal — then she's gone again while someone else raises her and decides if I deserve more time. I don't sleep, I don't trust, I think about this every single day, and it has cost me my peace, my relationships, and pieces of my daughter's childhood I will never get back. Corrine came back to me anxious, clingy, and carrying a worry no 7-year-old should have — and she is still carrying it. We are both still carrying it.

— AMBER

This system turned my children's lives into a maze of restrictions, gatekeeping, and delayed justice, while rewarding the people who controlled access to them and punishing me for trying to remain their mother. It fractured our family, distorted ordinary parent-child relationships into suspicion and supervision, and forced us to live for years under decisions that were never grounded in clear, timely, testable evidence

— ANNA

The court stole my daughter and trafficked her to a pedophile, all for financial gain. My daughter has endured substantial harm and was taken from a safe and loving home with me.

— CHRISTA

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

This county had 2 cases found nothing went for guardianship over our daughter because jfs would not leave her alone. The Magistrate from that hearing ordered our grandson removed immediately because she didn't want our grandson growing up like our daughter

— GEORGE

There are no words or way to describe the mix of grief, pain, shame, confusion, anger and fear I face from the second I wake up until the moment I close my eyes.

— STEVIE

This system has caused my family and I extreme stress, countless sleepless nights, missed work due to repeated court appearances that are often postponed, and an overwhelming number of appointments, while requiring unnecessary parenting classes despite my successful experience raising children. I feel I have been expected to follow policies that do not meet this child's individual needs and, in my experience, have set him up for failure rather than success.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They have let the mother keep child and continue to ignore all court orders. Guardian sides with her even though child is failing in school and now obese at 9 years old. He has behavioral issues that are getting worse.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I am the alienated parent, this has caused me to have PTSD and the total loss of custody, my parenting time and my parental rights now my daughter is an adult. The damage is already done but I have been through unimaginable stress and loss grieving my daughter that is still alive because of the lies and decisions of someone else. I missed out on so much of my daughter's life, memories and her graduation from high school that I can never replace or get back because of this system that chose to turn their back on me as a loving mother.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

The system enabled psychological, financial, litigation and post-separation emotional abuse by ignoring evidence, failing to conduct an impartial investigation into alienation and hold countering parent accountable for loss of all contact with my child whose unaddressed mental health crisis required inpatient stabilization for suicidal ideation with multiple plans and intent.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The court is destroying my child. He's being abused and neglected by his dad and stepmom, and even after proving everything, none of the officials will do anything about it. Their solution was "let's put it in writing". When I told them that wouldn't matter, and he would continue violating everything as he has been, they insisted this was the way to go, and that I would have to come back and pay a lot more money to come after him again. The court is bankrupting me!

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system has killed me slowly. They have taken out my heart and just stomped on it. My ex won't let my daughter talk to me or my family. The whole family has been affected by this awful court.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

it seems like every time somebody goes into this court in my family they seem to hold the grandmother against them I don't know what it is about her but they just hate her

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Killed me and my family

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This system is a joke. They gave custody of my son to a man actively under investigation for molesting a minor and who admitted on the stand to 3 felonies and having a child porn problem.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

This has mentally and emotionally drained my kids and I don't want to think negatively anymore I'm praying to be able to help with the same ones affected by this situation and give them encouragement and thank GOD for the strength to be here for him to get ALL THE PRAISE AND GLORY AND let the world know that if it wasn't for Jesus i would have not been able to come out of this nightmare and I don't want to pass any souls that The Lord has for me to come into contact with to be thinking that they are not enough for the kids or child we are doing well and I will continue to pray for others and believe in Jesus name for the reunification of us having that happy ending to all of us in the world I'm proud of you for not giving up and being there to help me and everyone else that is or will be in this situation to Hold fast and press on no matter what it seems like with God anything is POSSIBLE IF WE ONLY BELIEVE ANS KEEP BELIEVING AND TRUSTING HIM IN GOOD AND NOT GOOD, IN TRIALS AND VALLEY ARE HELP COME FROM THE LORD ❤️

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

My ex wanted to punish me for leaving him, and the court helped him do it. My ex is an irresponsible man, and this decision cost my son his life. MVA, just after his 16th bday.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Total alienation from my daughter, assaulted physically, sheriff good ol boys refused reports every time I wanted one, denied access to my daughter was not allowed to file contempt, denied medical attention by sheriff when assaulted causing bodily harm, physically and mentally exhausted, broke, alination from my daughter., ptsd

— RHIANNA

The overt actions and inaction of bad actors within the family court system have forced my child to endure ongoing emotional and physical harm while I have been drained emotionally, financially, professionally and psychologically trying to protect her. Instead of intervening to stop the suffering, the family court system has partnered with the juvenile court system to intentionally keep both of us trapped in prolonged trauma.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

The system has introduced violence, manipulation, conditional love, ugliness, and worries we've never known. ALL THAT WE THOUGHT WAS A POSSIBLE NIGHTMARE HAS BECOME OUR REALITY. The 4th of July used to be our favorite holiday to celebrate. This year? We cried inside our house because when we go in public, people hurt us. We have no safe place to go. We have never known a life where we cannot move freely in the world. But now it's all we worry about, because ANYONE can misinterpret our actions, generate a rumor, and actually have a child abducted. IT IS THE SCARIEST EXPERIENCE OF OUR LIVES.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This has really made things hard for our family. We didn't sign a case plan so they arrested us. I now have cameras up everywhere because I don't trust anyone. I have ptsd from this and nightmares. They are forcing our daughter to say things to fit their narrative and she does it because she wants them to leave her alone. She doesn't even like the case worker. We feel like we're stuck in a hole that we can't get out of. It's not right.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Magistrate X, you moved my son 1,000 miles away and while not even spending the paltry 75 days with me, G somehow blames me for everything wrong in his life and has cut me out of his life. If that's not parental alienation, I don't know what is. Your choice to have G live with that man was wrong and will sadly affect him, his mental health, as well as all of his Ohio family for the rest of our lives.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I believe that it boils down to which parent has the most money and can pay for representation. My daughter is 21 years old now and has an emotional issues because of what her father has done. Parent alienation is real and I submitted evidence that he was doing this to my daughter and it was looked over. The last time we went to court, I was told if he continued to act in the same manner that we could go to court once again.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

204 full approved Ohio comments are included in this appendix.

07 HOW TO READ THIS REPORT

WHAT THIS IS

The Family Rights Registry is a public, parent-reported data collection run by Stand With Meg. Every figure in this Ohio report comes from Ohio respondents who voluntarily submitted survey entries about their experience inside family court and/or CPS.

This report is built to help families, advocates, reporters, and legislators see the patterns emerging in Ohio — not to replace formal research, and not to name individual judges or counties as responsible parties.

WHAT IT ISN'T

This is not a representative sample. Respondents self-select. The 272 Ohio families reporting here are not the universe of Ohio families in court — they are the families who found the survey, trusted it enough to submit, and told us what happened to them.

Financial figures are self-reported. Response counts and percentages use the number of families who answered that specific topic or financial field. The Median Family Burden headline is the median of total reported expenses across families who reported in three or more expense categories. Quotes are minimally edited.

METHODOLOGY · FAMILY RIGHTS REGISTRY

Data in this report was collected April 2024 – July 2026 through standwithmeg.com/family-rights-survey. Submissions are timestamped. Duplicate-submission heuristics use normalized email + location, with direct survey rows preferred over legacy rows and the newest row retained within each source. Categorical responses from multi-select and short-answer fields are normalized monthly.

Dollar fields exclude blank, negative, and obvious data-entry artifact values above the report's field caps. When asset-loss values contain a strong statistical outlier, the asset-loss mean and total are suppressed and only the median is reported. Lost-wage, attorney-fee, and asset-loss entries are self-reported and not corroborated against tax records or court filings.

Geographic reporting uses the county or regional field as submitted, with light normalization (e.g. "Butte silverbow" → "Butte–Silver Bow"). Quotes carry one of three public permission states: *Anonymous*, *First-name only*, or *Full attribution with consent to public use*. Court actor names appear only after 3 independent families name the same actor.

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ABOUT THIS REPORT

This report is based on self-reported survey submissions collected by Stand With Meg. Counts and categories reflect responses available at the time this packet was generated.

This report is for informational and advocacy use only, not legal advice or an official government record.

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